



World Food Programme

SAVING
LIVES
CHANGING
LIVES



AFGHANISTAN

COUNTRY BRIEF
JULY 2026

IN NUMBERS



1.9 million people assisted in June 2026
(49% female)



2,700 mt food distributed in June 2026



USD 6.9 M cash transferred in June 2026



USD 492 M (July – Dec 2026) net funding requirements

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- After a prolonged pipeline break, more than 1,600 mt of the approximately 6,000 mt of nutrition commodities expected in the country have arrived, enabling WFP to reach 80,000 children and 25,000 mothers.
- Since early July, funding shortfalls have forced WFP to suspend famine-prevention programmes in hotspot areas, putting 1.5 million people at risk of life-threatening hunger.
- Funding constraints have also forced WFP to suspend cash assistance at all border crossings, leaving vulnerable returning families without critical support.

SITUATION OVERVIEW

- Regional conflicts are exacerbating the humanitarian crisis in Afghanistan, with staple food prices at elevated levels and transport costs tripling due to prolonged border closure with Pakistan, re-routed supply chains due to the conflict in the Middle East, and increased fuel prices. These supply chain pressures are particularly acute for imported specialized nutritious foods (SNFs), with most WFP-supported health clinics currently facing a stock out of these commodities.
- At the same time, Afghanistan is experiencing record levels of acute malnutrition, with 3.7 million children under five and 1.2 million pregnant and breastfeeding women affected in 2026. The shortage of nutrition supplies, combined with funding constraints, means that one million malnourished children will be unable to receive life-saving assistance this year.
- Since early July, WFP's famine-prevention programmes in hotspot areas have been suspended, putting 1.5 million people at heightened risk of life-threatening hunger. Overall, WFP is now forced to turn away 13 million acutely hungry Afghans.
- In addition, funding constraints have compelled WFP to suspend cash assistance for returnees from Iran and Pakistan at all border crossings, leaving vulnerable families without critical support upon arrival.

Reporting Period: June 2026

Photo Caption & Credit: Children at Maiwand Primary School in Paktika province receive fortified biscuits. WFP/Isheeta Sumra

OPERATIONAL UPDATES

General Food Assistance

- In June, WFP assisted over 1.9 million people, delivering nearly 2,700 mt of food and USD 6.9 million in cash-based transfers. Despite the proven effectiveness of WFP's famine-prevention programmes in hotspot areas, severe funding shortfalls have forced the suspension of these life-saving interventions from July.
- WFP was also forced to phase out returnee assistance in June due to critical funding constraints, leaving more than 400,000 vulnerable Afghan returnees without cash-for-food assistance upon arrival.

Nutrition

- Despite the arrival of over 1,600 mt of nutrition commodities – enough to support 80,000 children and 25,000 mothers – and ongoing nutrition programmes through 1,756 health facilities and 74 health posts, worsening food insecurity, recurrent shocks, and large-scale returns continue to drive needs. Severe funding shortfalls mean WFP expects to reach only one in seven acutely malnourished women and children in 2026.

School-Based Assistance

- In June, WFP provided 149 mt of targeted food assistance, including Bread+, fortified biscuits and Samosa, to 625,000 primary school children in Farah, Nangarhar, Ghor, Jwazjan, Nuristan, Paktika, Samangan, Uruzghan, and Zabul provinces.

Maternal and Child Benefit Programme

- Through the World Bank-funded maternal and child benefit programme (inclusive of the MCBP Earthquake Response), approximately 9,500 pregnant women and mothers of children under the age of 5 years received Social and Behaviour Change Communication (SBCC) on nutrition, health, and immunization, and USD 643,000 in cash assistance.

Resilience and Livelihood Support

- WFP continued to implement resilience activities across 50 districts in 21 provinces, reaching over 14,600 households, including nearly 3,900 female-headed households. Support focused on

strengthening food security, climate resilience, and livelihoods through community asset creation, skills development, agricultural and livestock assistance, and cash-based support. Key infrastructure, including irrigation canals, protection walls, feeder roads, and watershed structures, was completed and handed over to communities. WFP also worked with partners and technical teams to design the next phase of resilience programming, drawing on lessons learned, community consultations, and risk analysis to ensure future interventions remain responsive to local priorities and climate risks.

UN Humanitarian Air Service (UNHAS)

- UNHAS operated a total of 178 flights to 12 destinations and facilitated the movement of approximately 1,115 passengers from 52 organizations, including UN agencies, donors and non-governmental organizations.

Supply Chain and Logistics

- The long-lasting closure of the Pakistan border and the suspension of the Dubai–Iran supply route have continued to disrupt food deliveries to Afghanistan. Alternative corridors via the Lapis Lazuli route and through Türkiye and Northern Iran are helping restore supplies, with around 6,000 mt of specialized nutritious foods and vegetable oil beginning to arrive through these northern and western routes, enabling the gradual resumption of nutrition activities. However, transport costs have roughly tripled due to longer distances and multiple transshipment points. Efforts to clear humanitarian cargo stranded in Pakistan since October 2025 have also progressed during the reporting period.

Country Director Mission to the UK

- WFP Afghanistan Country Director, John Aylieff, visited London on 8–9 June and met UK Government officials, members of the All-Party Parliamentary Group (APPG) on Nutrition for Development, media outlets, and humanitarian partners to discuss the worsening humanitarian situation in Afghanistan. The visit made a strong case for continued support to WFP's operations and highlighted the urgency of addressing escalating humanitarian needs amid growing

funding constraints. He also stressed the importance of mobilizing additional support from strategic donors with an interest in the region. See the BBC News interview [here](#).

Stories from the Field

Hanifa is one of 1,160 participants supported through the MCBP Nutrition-Sensitive Livelihoods intervention in Sayad District, Saripul Province. After her family sold their only productive assets to repay debts, she received business training and a livelihood grant to expand her food shop. The additional income has improved the family's access to food, reduced reliance on negative coping strategies, and enabled investment in poultry and rabbit farming. Her story demonstrates how nutrition-sensitive social protection and livelihood support can strengthen resilience, diversify incomes, and improve food security.



Right: Hanifa at her food shop in Englishkia Arabia village. Left: Trainer Fareshta Moradi conducts a follow-up visit.

WFP Afghanistan in the Media

The Telegraph: WFP warns of worsening hunger crisis in Afghanistan

In comments to *The Telegraph*, WFP Afghanistan's Country Director warned that conflict-related trade disruptions, rising costs and funding shortfalls are pushing an additional 2.3 million Afghans into food insecurity. Funding and logistical constraints are also forcing WFP to reduce assistance. Read the full article [here](#).

TCA: Termez logistics corridor remains a vital lifeline for Afghanistan

Marking the 25th anniversary of the Termez–Hairatan humanitarian corridor, WFP Afghanistan Country

Director highlighted its growing importance amid regional disruptions. He stressed that funding – not access – is now the main constraint. Read the full article [here](#).

WFP overcomes logistics challenges to deliver Indonesian biscuits to Afghan schoolchildren

WFP successfully delivered 397 mt of fortified biscuits donated by the Government of Indonesia after a 15,000 km journey across nine countries, overcoming border closures and regional instability. The USD3.5 million contribution will support 172,000 schoolchildren through WFP's school meals programme, providing a vital source of nutrition amid record levels of hunger and malnutrition.

The handover ceremony was featured on [WFP Afghanistan](#) and [WFP Global](#) social media channels.

Read the full article [here](#).



FUNDING OVERVIEW

Country Strategic Plan (2018-2027)

USD 492 M



Six-months net funding requirement
(July 2026 – December 2026)

13%

resourced

Donors

Canada, European Union, Finland, Germany, Iceland, Japan, Malta, Russian Federation, Sweden, Switzerland, United Kingdom and Private Donors.

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